

Prayers for our World and the Church

3rd May 2026

Psalm 40:1

I waited patiently for the Lord; He inclined to me and heard my cry.

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You that You are ever-ready to listen when we call upon You.

We acknowledge that we are sinners in need of a Saviour, and we thank You for sending Jesus to take our place on the Cross, to absorb the wrath of a holy God against our rebellion, and to free us from our condition of slavery to sin.

We thank You that we will shortly take part in the Lord's Supper, commemorating the Cross and the Resurrection.

We thank You for the Holy Spirit, Who is with us daily, enabling us to resist temptation, as well as comforting us as we support Jan at this time of Allan's passing into glory.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We thank You for the sure hope we have in Jesus' return as we pray for this world where so many live without any hope. We pray for peace in the many trouble spots around the globe, for strength and perseverance for missionaries near the front lines, ministering to the needs of refugees. We remember the persecuted church in places such as West Africa and East Asia, and the struggling churches in Europe which in past times were the home of the gospel.

We thank You for the many churches around Australia where Your Word is faithfully preached and lived, where that assurance of hope is declared boldly and ask that You would strengthen us to continue living according to Kingdom values rather than following the world's ways.

Ashburton

We pray for our work here at Ashburton, as we also labour with our various talents and abilities in the work of the Kingdom. We thank You for the PCV, and for the wisdom and support available to us from the Presbytery and Assembly. We pray that You would continue to strengthen Rod as our Moderator, as he serves the churches across Victoria, and our missionaries in many places.

We continue to pray for the Selection Committee, as they seek Your wisdom and direction in the search for a new minister of Your choosing, to lead Your work here. We pray for ourselves to support them in their work.

We continue in prayer for those in need of Your healing hand – for Diane and others affected by illness or injury. We again pray for Your strength and encouragement for Jan as she adjusts to life without Allan.

We thank You for Your Word, and for Rod as he preaches today. We pray that we would not miss what You bring us through him, but that we would hold fast to what is true.

In Jesus Precious Name we pray, Amen.

As we will shortly take part in the Lord's Supper, let us recall the fundamentals of our faith by reciting The Apostle's Creed:

I believe in God, the Father almighty,
creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit
and born of the virgin Mary.
He suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died, and was buried;
he descended to hell.
The third day he rose again from the dead.
He ascended to heaven
and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty.
From there he will come to judge the living and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic* church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and the life everlasting. Amen.